

Living Through Learning: Comprehensive Website Analysis and Redesign Plan

Living Through Learning (LTL) is a **registered non-profit organization (NPO)** in the South African education sector, focused on improving **foundation-phase literacy** among disadvantaged learners in Cape Town ¹. The current website (livingthroughlearning.org.za, with a linked e-learning shop) presents this mission through its branding ("Awakening Africa through education") and content. Key pages include **About Us** (Vision, Team, History), **Projects** (Current and Completed), **Success Stories**, **News & Media** (Press releases, newsletters), **Donors & Partners**, **Resources**, and **Contact**. For example, the homepage explains: "LTL is a registered NPO/PBO ... on assisting in foundation phase literacy. Located in Cape Town..." ¹. The site highlights LTL's unique pedagogy and outcomes (e.g. over 30,000 learners uplifted with literacy gains up to 80% ²) and includes calls to action (e.g. a "Donate Now" button linking to a PayFast donations page ³ ⁴).

Image: Children learning with digital reading tools in a classroom. The website emphasizes **interactive, hands-on learning**. Current programs like the Coronation Reading Adventure Room (CRAR) use phonics-based curricula (Words in Colour) and dedicated reading rooms. LTL reports that CRAR "commenced in 2010 with 4 schools and has grown to 31 (2019) schools... benefiting over 3000 learners and 105 educators per year" ⁵. Participating schools see 10–20% increases in reading scores ⁶. Embedding more student-centric visuals (like the image above) can reinforce this focus. LTL's content highlights outcomes: for example, its foundation literacy program has been used by 30,000+ learners with up to 80% literacy improvement ². The *Our Success* section also lists metrics (900 learners reached, 40 educators trained, etc ⁷), though these may need updating. To improve storytelling, the new site could integrate infographics or charts summarizing these impacts (for example, quoting "80% average score increase" ²) alongside the narrative.

Content and Messaging

The site's **messaging** is clear on mission and approach but can be made more concise and SEO-friendly. The homepage and About pages use inspiring language (e.g. "Awakening Africa through Early Literacy," "Learners are national assets" ⁸ ¹). The Mission is spelled out ("provide training and interventions to support educators and learners... developing literacy levels, igniting educators' passion..." ⁹). These statements are strong, but some copy is lengthy and repetitive (especially in Success Stories). For the new site, key messages should be highlighted with bullet points or brief headings, and success metrics should be front-and-center to build credibility. The website currently has **no obvious meta descriptions or keyword-focused headings** (at least none visible), so SEO can be improved: for example, page titles and headings should include phrases like "Cape Town literacy program," "foundation-phase reading," etc. Images should have descriptive alt text (e.g. "child learning to read"), and each page should have a concise meta-description summarizing its content. The blog/news section (Media Days, newsletters) provides fresh content but could be more prominent: adding an easily accessible news/blog feed on the homepage would keep the site dynamic and boost SEO.

Current Content Structure: The main navigation includes: - **About Us** (Vision & Mission, Team, History), - **Current Projects** (CRAR, Educator Training, GrandWest Reading Room), - **Completed Projects** (e.g. Achievers Programme, STEP 4, Remedial classes, ACSA Literacy Rooms, Capsule), - **Success Stories** (testimonials, program outcomes), - **In the News** (media articles, events, newsletters), -

Our Donors & Partners (lists of sponsors like Coronation, ACSA, Rolf Stephan Nussbaum, etc.), - **Resources** (overview of LTL's teaching materials), and **Contact Us** (inquiries, donation and volunteer info). Key calls-to-action include "Make a donation now" (linking to a PayFast form) and "Visit our E-Learning Shop" (linking to shop.livingthroughlearning.org.za).

To make all content work harder, we should ensure: - **Consistent tone and branding:** Use unified voice (warm, professional) and consistent color scheme (the current green/white palette and logo).

- **Concise program descriptions:** For each project page, summarize goals and outcomes (e.g. "Wild About Reading" page notes 160 learners benefited daily and a 5% literacy gain in 180 hours ¹⁰ ¹¹). Such stats can be pulled out as bullet points or callouts.

- **Testimonials in summary form:** The "Success Stories" page has long teacher narratives. These can be distilled into shorter quotes and paired with the educator's name/school, to quickly illustrate impact.

Visual Design and User Experience

The existing site uses large banner images and photography (e.g. slides "Awakening Africa through education", "Changing lives"), but the layout is fairly traditional/boxy. To modernize:

- **Responsive, mobile-first design:** Ensure the site adapts to phones/tablets. Current layouts (fixed-width sliders, multi-column sections) should be updated to a fluid grid with readable text on small screens.

- **High-quality imagery:** Replace or augment stock/old photos with vibrant images of LTL activities. (For example, *the image below* shows students in the "Wild About Learning" room.) This conveys energy and authenticity.

Image: Learners and facilitators in a colorful "Wild About Learning" literacy room. Projects like the GrandWest Wild About Reading Room vividly illustrate LTL's hands-on approach. The current design uses similar photos, but the rebuild should use **full-width banners** and image galleries to engage visitors. Incorporating short video clips (e.g. classroom activities or testimonials) would also showcase LTL in action. Consistent typography (a clean sans-serif for body text, and a readable serif or bold font for headings) will improve readability. Color-wise, the existing palette of green/teal (from the logo) and white can be maintained, but adding a bright accent color (e.g. orange or purple) for buttons/links will make calls-to-action (Donate, Volunteer) pop out.

- **Navigation improvements:** The current header menu has many items (some appearing twice in mobile dropdown). We should streamline categories and use dropdown menus logically. For example, group all "Projects" under one menu rather than separate "Current" and "Completed." Include a clear "Donate" button in the top bar. A sticky header (always visible) can improve usability.
- **Accessibility:** Ensure good contrast (text vs background), alt text on all images, and proper heading structure (only one H1, etc.). The site's "skip to content" link is good – preserve such features.

Shop and Interactive Features

LTL's **E-Learning Shop** (shop.livingthroughlearning.org.za) is currently a separate site with bundled literacy kits (e.g. "Birdie Bundle," "Story Readers"). In a redesign, the shop should **feel integrated** with the main brand. This could mean matching the visual theme and linking seamlessly. On the main site, the "Visit E-Learning Shop" banner should clearly showcase products: for example, adding a few featured product images or descriptions to entice visitors. If possible, integrating the shop catalog or product teasers on the main site (instead of a simple link) would keep users engaged. All purchase and

cart pages should be easy to navigate, with clear images and descriptions of the reading/material bundles, emphasizing benefits (e.g. “Motor and literacy skills in one kit”).

Donors, Contact & Localization

The current site prominently lists donors (Coronation, ACSA, GrandWest, etc.) with logos ¹². The redesign should keep a “Partners” section to build trust, perhaps with more dynamic logos. The Contact page encourages visitors and donors: e.g. “All donations go through our PayFast account” ⁴. We should keep a visible donation button (with secure PayFast icon) and clearly present the bank/PayFast details. Because LTL mainly serves **Cape Town and surrounds**, the site should reflect this local focus: include a map or list of schools served, and occasionally mention regional context (like Western Cape literacy stats). If there are local languages involved (the site is currently English-only), consider small sections translated into Afrikaans/Xhosa for inclusivity.

Benchmarking and Competitor Insights

Other South African literacy NGOs (e.g. **READ to RISE**, **Wordworks**, **Nal’ibali**) often use storytelling and data to engage audiences. For example, READ to RISE highlights national literacy challenges and invites supporters with a clear donation campaign ¹³. The new LTL site can similarly emphasize urgency: quoting relevant stats (e.g. “81% of SA Grade 4s are functionally illiterate” ¹³) in a sidebar or impact section would underscore LTL’s mission. Such sites also use friendly, colorful designs and have easy-to-find volunteer forms. Incorporating features like a newsletter sign-up (in the footer or sidebar) and social media integration (live Twitter/Instagram feed) will help with engagement and SEO.

Key Recommendations

- **Content Rewrite:** Distill long paragraphs into clear bullet points and concise sections. Emphasize measurable outcomes (e.g. “10–20% reading improvement” ⁶, “600 learners benefited” ¹⁴). Use headings with keywords (“Foundation Literacy,” “Teacher Training,” “Learning Adventures”).
- **Modern Design:** Adopt a responsive theme with flexible grids. Use the embedded images above as inspiration for lively content. Add icons or infographics to break up text (e.g. a chart icon next to “80% literacy improvement”). Ensure prominent buttons (e.g. **Donate** and **Volunteer**) are colored and always visible.
- **Navigation & Structure:** Group pages into logical categories (About, Programs, Impact, Get Involved). Simplify the menu and include a search bar.
- **SEO Optimization:** Add unique meta titles/descriptions for each page (e.g. “Living Through Learning – Foundation Phase Literacy Program in Cape Town”), and use heading tags (H1, H2) with target phrases. All images (like those of children learning) should have meaningful alt-text to rank in image search.
- **Interactive Features:** Consider adding a brief introductory video or slideshow on the homepage. A blog or news feed (currently “Media Days”) should be regularly updated and summarized on the homepage (e.g. “Latest: Miss SA visits our Reading Room”).
- **Localization:** Highlight Cape Town focus (perhaps a map of Western Cape with marked partner schools), and consider multi-language support if relevant.
- **Shop Integration:** Make the e-shop visually consistent and easy to navigate. Include a short description of the shop on the main site (“Our e-learning store offers reading kits and workbooks for home and school learning”).
- **Social Proof:** Showcase testimonials in quote cards (short excerpts from teachers or parents) rather than long blocks of text. Maintain the newsletter archive but add a signup form.

By applying these enhancements, the rebuilt Living Through Learning site will be more user-friendly, visually engaging, and effective at communicating impact – ultimately attracting more supporters and better serving the community.

Sources: LTL's current website content and project pages ¹ ⁵ ¹⁵ ¹⁰ ¹² ⁴ , which detail the organization's mission, programs, outcomes, and donor partnerships. These informed the analysis and recommendations above.

¹ ² ³ ⁷ ⁹ Living through Learning | Awakening Africa through education
<https://livingthroughlearning.org.za/>

⁴ Contact Living through learning
<https://livingthroughlearning.org.za/contact/>

⁵ ⁶ Coronation Reading Adventure Room (CRAR) - Living Through Learning
<https://livingthroughlearning.org.za/current-projects/coronation-reading-adventure-room-crar/>

⁸ our Vision and Mission at Living through Learning
<https://livingthroughlearning.org.za/about/vision-and-mission/>

¹⁰ ¹¹ GrandWest: Wild About Reading Room - Living Through Learning - LTL
<https://livingthroughlearning.org.za/grandwest-wild-about-reading-room/>

¹² The Living Through Learning Donors & Partners
<https://livingthroughlearning.org.za/about/vision-and-mission/our-donors/>

¹³ Read to Rise Literacy NGO South Africa
<https://www.readtorise.co.za/>

¹⁴ Literacy Action Rooms
<https://livingthroughlearning.org.za/airports-company-south-africa-literacy-action-rooms/>

¹⁵ Educator Training and Forums - Living Through Learning - LTL
<https://livingthroughlearning.org.za/current-projects/educator-training-and-forums/>